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VSCO's iPhone camera
app is now available
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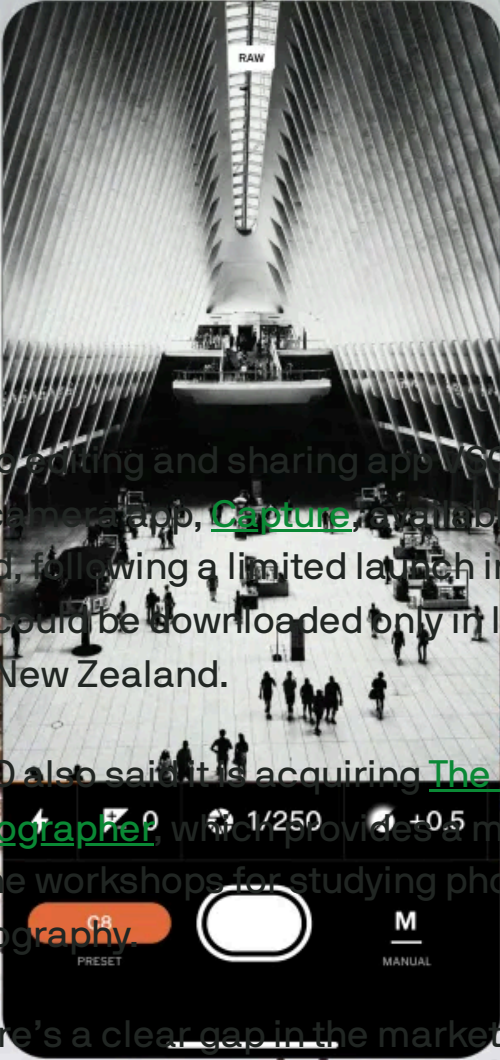


Photo editing and sharing app VSCO is making its iOS camera app, [Capture](#), available across the world, following a limited launch in June, when the app could be downloaded only in Ireland, Australia, and New Zealand.

VSCO also said it is acquiring [The Freelance Photographer](#), which provides a mix of online and offline workshops for studying photography and videography.

“There’s a clear gap in the market for business education and industry-specific guidance for emerging photography professionals who are looking to secure sustainable client relationships. The Freelance Photographer serves as a long-term career partner to creatives, offering a comprehensive education, a supportive community, as well as the tools and insight they need to turn their craft into a career,” Eric Wittman, CEO of VSCO, said in a statement.

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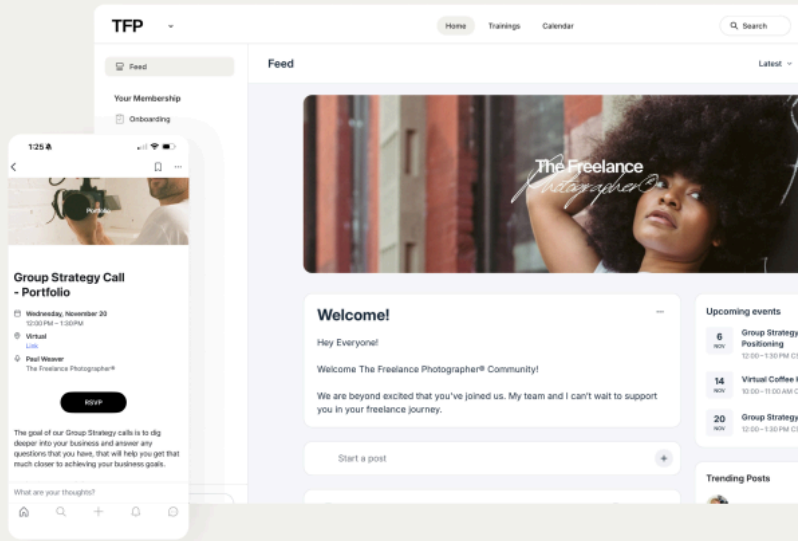


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VSCO’s first new app in more than a decade, Capture focuses on taking pictures with a set aesthetic. The app has more than 50 presets for images along with some real-time effects. It offers manual control over camera functions like shutter speed and exposure, and can take pictures in RAW and ProRAW formats. The app also lets users sync all photos with VSCO’s cloud through the VSCO app, which means you can’t directly upload photos from the Capture app.



The Freelance Photographer offers various courses, starting from \$208 per month for the basic coaching plan, and a \$625 per month that gives subscribers access to over 50 tools, several courses, and personal mentoring from the company’s founder, Paul Weaver.

The acquisition fits neatly into VSCO's aim of catering more to professional photographers. Last year, the company launched [VSCO Hub](#), to enable brands to discover photographers for different projects, and [VSCO Sites](#), which lets photographers create web pages to show off their work. In May, the company launched [VSCO Canvas](#), a collaborative whiteboard product that lets users create moodboards for different projects.

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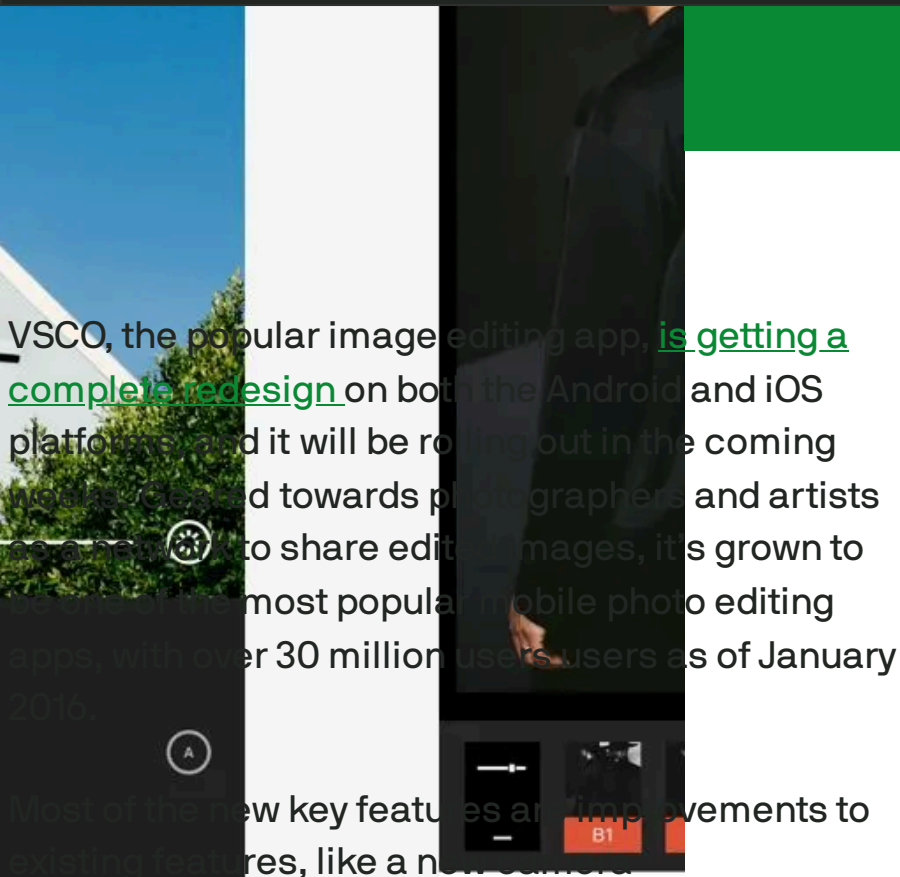
Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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VSCO, the popular image editing app, [is getting a complete redesign](#) on both the Android and iOS platforms, and it will be rolling out in the coming weeks. Geared towards photographers and artists as a new way to share edited images, it's grown to become one of the most popular mobile photo editing apps, with over 30 million users as of January 2016.

Most of the new key features are improvements to existing features, like a new camera interface, gesture-based navigation, a redesigned personal space for images and journal posts within the VSCO network and better management of friends.

Other new features to note are a standard design language for both versions of the app, as well as bug fixes and speed improvements.

As a quick refresher: VSCO launched in 2011, is based in Oakland, California and has an office in New York City. In terms of its Series A funds, [VSCO raised \\$40M two years ago](#), with another \$30M raised last year.

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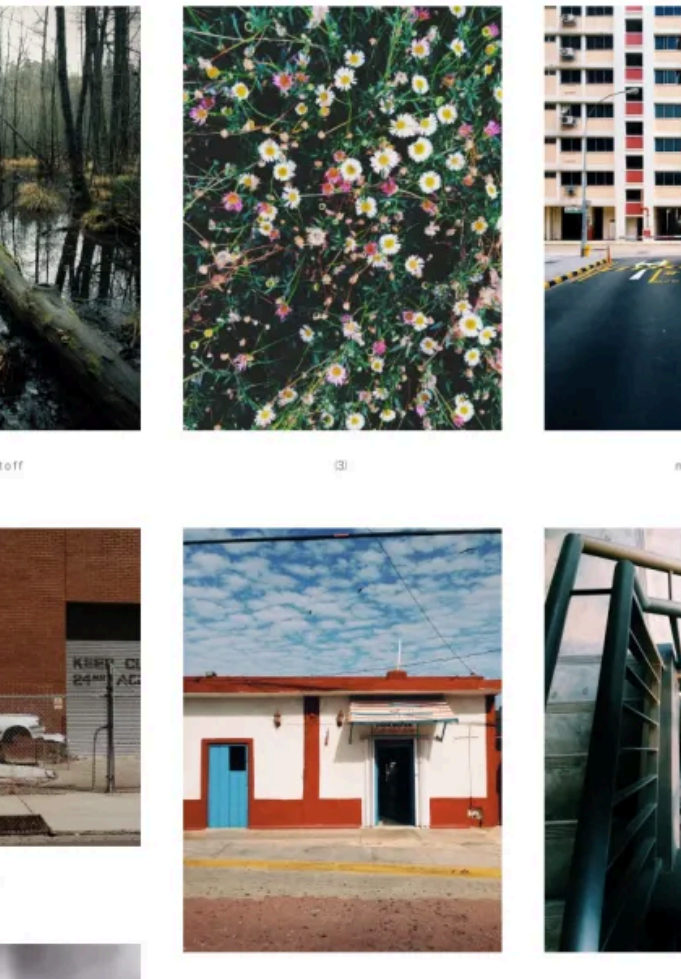
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VSCO Pulls In \$40M Series A To Build Out Its Photo-Focused Creative Community

Natasha Lomas — 6:48 AM PDT · May 6, 2014

Time was when digital photographers coalesced on Flickr. But Flickr languished, and the community it

had built was allowed to disperse — leaving room for others to sprout in its place. One of those is [VSCO](#) — a creative platform for photographers and designers to share quality work.

The company, which was founded back in March 2011, has just pulled in a \$40 million Series A round from [Accel Partners](#) — the fifth largest Series A round the investor has ever done. [Goldcrest Investments](#) also participated in the round.

In a [blog](#) announcing the investment Accel said it was drawn to the “raw creativity VSCO fosters on its platform” — and the “beautiful, emotive photos and images” that users create and upload to the community.

VSCO’s combination of “great tools” and a “passionate community” is the recipe for investment success here.

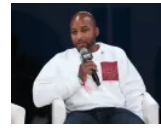
Accel also specifically lauds VSCO’s mobile tools — with its [VSCOcam app](#) — which it says lay the groundwork for further growth of VSCO’s community as the camera hardware that’s embedded in smartphones continues to improve.

The purchase of dedicated high-end photography equipment is no longer a pre-requisite for producing high quality images — and the mobile tools VSCO offers help to bridge the gap between high end pro camera kit and high end smartphones.

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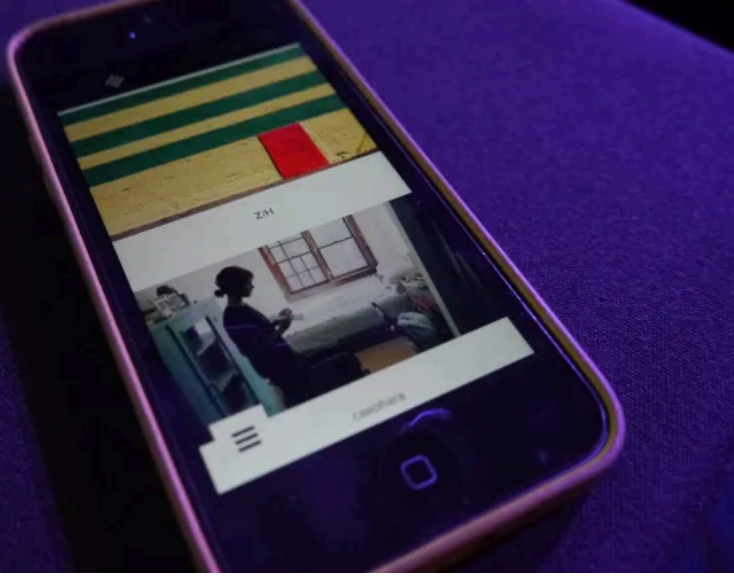
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VSCO's mobile app includes filters for post processing images shot within the app, but also offers greater precision for editing the images than mainstream photo-sharing and social networking apps. Accel notes that some 30 million images uploaded to Instagram are tagged #VSCO or #VSCOcam, for instance.

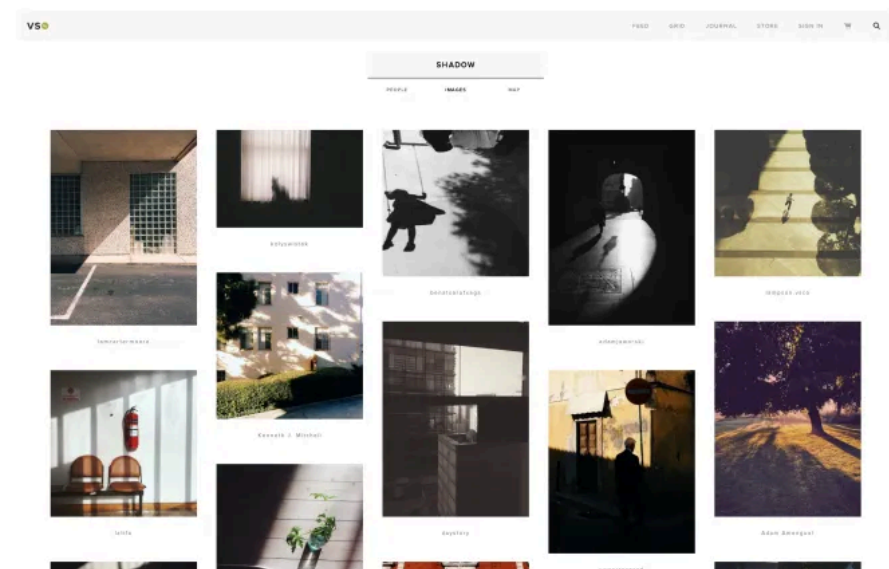
The photo-focused company does not reveal the exact size of its user-base, arguing that the measure is less appropriate for a community

fixated on encouraging the creation of quality user generated content. In an email to TechCrunch, co-founder and CEO Joel Flory described the “community of creatives” using VSCO products as “largely international, extremely passionate and rapidly growing”.

Indeed, he added that putting numbers on a creative community misses the point — being exactly the kind of reductionism that the community has been established to counteract.

“We like to think of VSCO Grid, our minimalist photo publishing platform, as a living museum. In a museum, the focus is completely on the artwork and the artist who has created it. It is a beautiful, curated experience. With that mindset, VSCO Grid doesn’t show follower count or allow comments as that would be like writing on the museum wall or putting gold star stickers next to artwork you liked. VSCO Grid is not a ‘social currency’ platform – it is built on beautiful, original content and curation,” he said.

“We also carefully select images every day for the curated [VSCO Grid](#). The curated Grid shows a wide range of images from around the world (our community is over 70% international) that are absolutely beautiful, but would largely be ignored on sharing communities that may not value the same things.”



Prior to this round, VSCO was bootstrapping profitably — selling a variety of products to its community of enthusiasts via its online and in-app stores — with nearly 50 employees and “millions” of domestic and international users. More than one billion images have been created using VSCO’s tools to date.

VSCO’s first funding will be used for building more tools and services for the VSCO community and expanding the team further.

“The founders have a big vision for the platform, and with this investment, can finally match the passion and energy of a user-base that’s grown non-linearly from the start. The company is also announcing a significant expansion of its [Artist’s Initiative](#), a grant-based program that supports artists and their mission-driven creative projects across the world,” said Accel.

The scholarship fund started at \$100,000 but has now been expanded to \$1 million, with Accel contributing \$500,000 to help beef up the size of the fund.

“We believe that if we “win” as a company, we only do so if the creative community does as well. We are in this together. With this in mind, we launched the VSCO Artist Initiative, a one million dollar fund for artists to pursue their creative vision. From

photographers to muralists, the work being created by this next generation of artists is simply amazing, and we are honored to support them,” said Flory.

“We have a massive, unrealized vision to redefine the entire process around creating, editing, sharing and connecting,” he added. “This [Series A] investment allows us to better scale our infrastructure for the international community, which represents the majority of the VSCO community. This will greatly improve the performance of VSCO Cam, VSCO Grid and VSCO Journal, among others.”

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Natasha was a senior reporter for TechCrunch, from September 2012 to April 2025, based in Europe. She joine...

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